Some buildings on fire?

Oh, wow, where's that?

New York.

I tried to see the screen through all the boys massed in the room. I asked the boy to my right what was going on.

He said America was under attack.

Terrorists had flown planes into the Twin Towers in New York City.

People were…jumping. From the tops of buildings half a kilometer high.

More and more boys gathered, stood around, biting their lips, their nails, tugging their ears. In stunned silence, in boyish confusion, we watched the only world we'd ever known disappear in clouds of toxic smoke.

World War Three, someone muttered.

Someone propped open the blue doors. Boys kept streaming in.

None made a sound.

So much chaos, so much pain.

What can be done? What can we do?

What will we be called to do?

Days later I turned seventeen.

31.

I'D OFTEN SAY IT TO MYSELF first thing in the morning: *Maybe this is the day*.

I'd say it after breakfast: *Maybe she's going to reappear this morning.*

I'd say it after lunch: *Maybe she's going to reappear this afternoon.*

It had been four years, after all. Surely she'd established herself by now, forged a new life, a new identity. *Maybe, at long last, she's going to emerge today, hold a press conference—shock the world.* After answering the shouted questions from the astonished reporters, she'd lean into the microphone: *William! Harry! If you can hear me, come to me!*

At night I had the most elaborate dreams. They were essentially the same, though the scenarios and costumes were slightly different. Sometimes she'd orchestrate a triumphant return; other times I'd simply bump into her somewhere.